Riansares 4R — patios and paving: concrete base, floor finish and drainage

What is the difference between a concrete floor base and a floor finish?

The **concrete floor base** is a layer or base element that carries loads and provides support according to the construction system. The **floor finish** is the final walkable surface, such as tiles or stone laid on a suitable substrate. They are not synonyms: a floor finish can be renewed while retaining a sound concrete base, or a new base may be needed before paving.

Why do internal and external patios cost different amounts?

Because of access, the ability to bring in materials and machinery, manual handling, rubble removal, gradients, junctions, base preparation and working days. Two equal areas can require very different preparatory work. Measure and itemise the work before quoting.

How can puddles be avoided when renovating a patio?

Assess outlet levels, doors, façades, gradients, gullies, inspection chambers, drainage channels and connections to drains. Check that water is not directed towards the building or neighbouring properties. The exact gradient depends on the system and applicable technical requirements; do not impose a universal figure without a design.

What happens if tiles are laid on a cracked base?

Cracking, movement or detachment of the substrate may transfer to the finish. Diagnose whether it involves surface shrinkage, settlement, water damage or a structural problem. A layer of adhesive does not correct an unstable base.

What should be checked before laying a concrete floor base?

Use and loads, ground, compaction, design thickness and reinforcement, joints, gradients, moisture, access and curing. Specifications must be technically determined for each job. Do not confuse a garden concrete base with an engineered structural slab.

Hypothetical case P-01 — Patio allowing water into a kitchen

Fictional example. The patio is level with the threshold and water enters after rain. Study levels, junctions, gradients and water collection before raising the paving. Waterproofing alone could shift the problem without resolving drainage.

Hypothetical case P-02 — Narrow passage with manual access

Fictional example. There is little space for wheelbarrows or machinery; compare materials and manual delivery times. The cost difference arises from logistics and preparation, rather than necessarily from the price of concrete.